



A COUNTRY JOURNEY GUIDE

OMAN / THE NORTHERN LOOP

# The Janoob Essential

*Mountain to desert. The northern loop.*

# the northern loop

The Janoob Essential is a 7-day introduction to Oman, beginning in Muscat before climbing into the villages and high roads of the Hajar Mountains. It moves from Wakan and Balad Sayt through Misfat, Nizwa and Jabal Akhdar, then trades cool mountain air for canyon

water in Wadi Hawer and a final night among the dunes of

Sharqiyah Sands. This is Janoob in its most concentrated form: mountain roads, local guesthouses, canyon swims, desert camps, shared meals and fires under open skies. Seven days, two chapters, and just enough road to leave you wanting more.

## 01 the hajar

Muscat · Wakan · Balad Sayt · Nizwa · Jabal Akhdar

## 02 water to sand

Wadi Hawer · Sharqiyah Sands

JOURNEY NOTES / 03

# the road, at a glance / what's included

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- the basics
- Airport pickup & final drop-off
- 7 days / 6 nights
- Janoob 4x4 transport across
- Oman Road trip
- different terrain, with cool land

cruisers of course...

- 3 guests plus driver per 4x4
- Accommodation & camping
- Self-drive available on request

## equipment

- Soft duffel bags preferred
- Breakfast, lunch & dinner unless
- stated otherwise
- Sleeping bags available to rent
- Guided activities & site access
- Water, coffee, tea & camp snacks

Vibes, campfires & good people.

the route is intended, not fixed.

## The road has the final say. Weather shifts, wadis rise, tides turn

- and the swell does whatever it wants. Plans may move with
- them - and honestly, that's part of traveling Janoob style.

## WHAT THIS JOURNEY ASKS OF YOU

- Comfort with long drives, active days, uneven ground and
  - sleeping outdoors. Guests become part of the crew: we
  - cook together, help with camp and leave room for the
- unexpected.



JOURNEY NOTES / 04

# days 01 - 02 / muscat to the mountains



## day 01

### settle in

### Muscat

HOTEL

AIRPORT TRANSFER

EASY

Welcome to Oman. We collect you from the airport and keep the rest of the day light: check in, recharge and meet the crew before the road begins.

## day 02

### city, then mountains

### Muscat to Wakan / Hadash

MOUNTAIN

2-3 HRS

STEADY

CAMP

We spend the morning exploring Muscat before the city falls away behind us. By late afternoon, the Hajar Mountains take over. First camp. First fire.

JOURNEY NOTES / 05

# days 033 – 044 / the western hajar



day 03

## rocks & villages

### Wakan / Hadash to Balad Sayt

LOCAL

4-5 HRS

ACTIVE

GUESTHOUSE

A morning on the rock, then mountain roads and off-road tracks through the Western Hajar. We reach Balad Sayt slowly and sleep under a local roof.

day 04

## village to summit

Balad Sayt to Misfat to Nizwa to Jabal Akhdar

MOUNTAIN

4 HRS IN STAGES

FULL DAY

CAMP

Mud houses, shaded farms and falaj channels in Misfat. Lunch and souq time in Nizwa. Sunset finds us high on Jabal Akhdar.

JOURNEY NOTES / 06

# days 05 - 07



day 05

## peaks to dunes

day 05

## peaks to pools

### Jabal Akhdar > Wadi Hawer

WILD CAMP

5-6 HRS

DEMANDING

High country first, canyon water next. After Wadi Hawer, the landscape opens and we keep moving east until the dunes take over. A long day, followed by a desert fire.

day 06

## canyon to desert

### Wadi Hawer > Sharqiyah Sands

DESERT CAMP

3 HRS

STEADY

A slow canyon morning before the landscape opens. By late afternoon we air down the tyres and drive into the dunes to choose our camp.

day 07

## desert morning. muscat evening

### Sharqiyah Sands > Muscat

DEPARTURE DAY

3 HR / AIRPORT TRANSFER

STEADY

Wake among the dunes, enjoy a final desert breakfast and take the long way out. We return to Muscat for airport drop-off or an optional additional hotel night.

JOURNEY NOTES / 07

# pack light.

- come ready.

## non-negotiable

### creature comforts

- Small daypack
- Camp pillow
- Swimwear and towel
- Book or Kindle
- Comfortable active clothing
- Camera or GoPro (if you didnt film
- Shoes with grip
- it, it didnt happen)
- Warm layers
- Lip balm
- Headlamp / Flashlight
- Bug spray
- Reusable water bottle
- Portable shatafa/bidet
- Sun protection
- Your favourite road snacks
- Personal toiletries
- power bank

#### SOFT DUFFLE BAGS ONLY!

- No hard suitcases, they don't
- go well with dunes or roof

racks.

- An open mind for long drives
- The best trips aren't just about where you go, they're about who you go with.

- Thanks for sharing the road and the moment. We'll see you out there.



ROUTE CHAPTER

# Field notes